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React Native vs Flutter in 2026: The \$5,000 Decision Most Startups Get Wrong

6 min read · Aug 18, 2026



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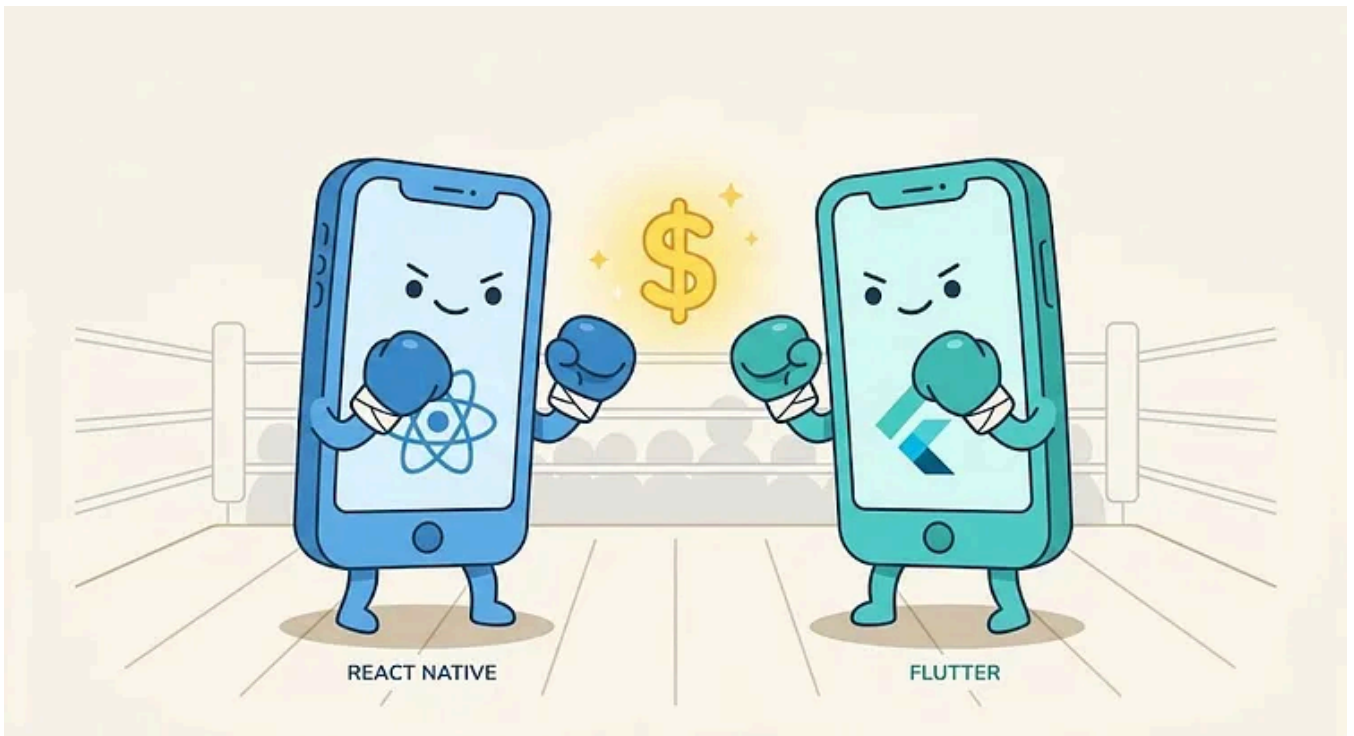
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A founder I know burned through roughly \$5,000 and four months building the same app twice. Wrong framework the first time. That's a car, a down payment, a runway extension, gone over one rushed architecture call.

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The \$5,000 fight most founders never see coming. — Generated using Ai

React Native and Flutter both build one codebase that ships to iPhone and Android. Both are free. Both are backed by tech giants. And picking between them is still one of the most argued-about calls in mobile dev.

By the end of this you'll know which one fits your team, what freelancers actually charge, who's using what in the real world, and how to start a career in either without wasting a year guessing.

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